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How and when AI-driven HRM promotes employee resilience and adaptive performance: A self-determination theory☆

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ABSTRACT

Despite growing research on AI in HRM, gaps remain, particularly in understanding the mechanisms through which AI-driven HRM influences employee outcomes. This study addresses this gap by developing a conceptual model to examine how AI-driven HRM impacts employee resilience and adaptive performance. Based on self-determination theory, the model proposes that employee exploration mediates the relationships between AI-driven HRM and employee outcomes. Additionally, trust in AI moderates these relationships. Two studies were conducted to test the hypotheses: Study 1 developed and validated a 12-item AI-driven HRM scale across three samples: 50 managers, 150 employees for exploratory factor analysis (EFA), and 150 employees for confirmatory factor analysis (CFA). Study 2, with data from 274 US employees through a three-wave survey, explored the effects of AI-driven HRM on resilience and performance. Results from Study 2 supported all proposed relationships, thereby offering important implications for both theory and practice in the AI-driven HRM field.

1. Introduction

Artificial intelligence (AI) is a domain of science and technology in which computers and software are empowered to execute specific functions by imitating or reproducing human thought processes and cognitive capabilities (Ali et al., 2023). This disruptive technology is rapidly changing work and society (Lepri et al., 2018), and has driven major policy shifts in organizations (Palos-Sánchez et al., 2022). The application of AI has transformed how organizations conduct business, design work, and augment work processes (Budhwar et al., 2022; Wilson & Daugherty, 2018). In many organizations, AI is integral to organizational innovation, process transformation, and competitive performance (Ransbotham et al., 2017, 2018). For example, there are 162 robots and AI per 10,000 employees globally in 2023, with an increase of 10 % in 2022 (International Federation of Robotics, 2023). As AI tools have superior computational ability, information processing, and data-driven hypothesis testing capacities relative to human counterparts (Balasubramanian et al., 2022), they can induce a 7 % increase in the global GDP and boost productivity growth by 1.5 % over 10 years (Goldman Sachs, 2023). New advances in AI are also expected to have a profound effect on global job markets, with 92 million jobs displaced and 170 million new roles created worldwide by 2025 (World Economic Forum, 2025). Given the increasing significance of AI, researchers highlight the need to integrate AI with HRM (Budhwar et al., 2023; Budhwar et al., 2022; Kiron, 2022; Pan et al., 2022; Prikshat, Islam, Patel, Malik, Budhwar & Gupta, 2023).

Several key themes have emerged in the AI literature. Some scholars have developed theoretical arguments to explore the current state of adopting AI-driven HRM and its implications for organizational outcomes, guiding future research (e.g., Budhwar et al., 2022; Margherita, 2022; Pereira et al., 2023). Others have conducted empirical studies to examine whether and how AI-driven HRM leads to various organizational outcomes (e.g., Budhwar et al., 2023; Cheng & Hackett, 2021; Chowdhury et al., 2023; Prikshat, Islam, Patel, Malik, Budhwar & Gupta, 2023). Another perspective examines the role of AI-driven interventions in shaping employee well-being alongside performance (e.g., Malik, Budhwar, Mohan & Srikanth, 2023; Nguyen & Malik, 2022; Xiao et al., 2023). Taken together, this line of research, whether conceptual or empirical, has yielded valuable insights into the evolution of AI and its effects on different organizational outcomes, including individual

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resilience and performance.

Despite a growing body of literature, key gaps remain. First, while extant studies have highlighted the critical significance of AI-driven interventions in HRM practices such as recruitment, performance management, and training (e.g., Prikshat et al., 2022), there is an absence of empirical research specifically investigating the underlying mechanisms through which such interventions influence employee resilience and performance. The study of AI-driven HRM is crucial for organizations, as it offers innovative tools and opportunities that enable employees to explore and develop new knowledge, skills, and roles in the AI era. This, in turn, allows organizations to adapt to and collaborate effectively with AI, thereby helping them achieve their strategic objectives. Fostering a culture of continuous learning, exploration, and development allows organizations to fully realize the benefits of AI-driven HRM systems (Xiao et al., 2023; Böhmer & Schinnenburg, 2023). Therefore, employee exploration may play a mediating role in the relationships between AI-driven HRM and employee resilience and adaptive performance. Unfortunately, despite the substantial research on AI-driven HRM, this area remains conceptually and theoretically undeveloped. Consequently, the field lacks a nuanced understanding of how AI-driven HRM elicits organizational outcomes. Despite AI being increasingly viewed as a crucial instrument in HRM, there is a notable scarcity of comprehensive academic research on the topic, indicating a deficiency in theoretical progression (Pan et al., 2022). In addition, despite the growing attention paid to AI-driven HRM research, no standardized definition or measure of AI-driven HRM is available in the literature. This gap hinders a comprehensive understanding of the AI-driven HRM domain and assessment of the effectiveness of such interventions.

In this study, we aim to address these gaps by positing two questions.

- RQ1. What role does employee exploration, that is, employees' openness to acquiring knowledge and learning new skills, play in the relationships between AI-driven HRM and employee resilience and adaptive performance?
- RQ2. Under what conditions can the mediated relationships between AI-driven HRM and employee resilience and adaptive performance be strengthened?

To answer these questions, this study examines the psychological processes through which AI-driven HRM impacts employee resilience and adaptive performance. Specifically, our objectives are as follows:

(i) To conceptualize and develop a measure of AI-driven HRM that highlights the role of HRM practices in shaping employee behavior to enhance organizational performance. We adopt an HRM behavioral perspective, positing that aligning HRM strategies with desired employee behaviors enables the achievement of strategic goals (Dumont et al., 2017; Wright, Dunford & Snell, 2001);
(ii) To explore the impact of AI-driven HRM on employee resilience and adaptive performance through the mediating effect of exploration, building on the self-determination theory (SDT) (Deci & Ryan, 1985; 2013; Ryan&Deci, 2017);
(iii) To unveil the conditional effect of employees' trust in AI on the mediated relationships between AI-driven HRM, employee exploration, and employee resilience/adaptive performance; and
(iv) To provide implications and practicalities for organizational leaders and HR specialists in managing AI and AI-driven HRM.

Our contributions are fourfold. First, drawing on SDT (Deci & Ryan, 1985, 2013) and the research call for exploring the relationship between AI, HRM, and a resilient and thriving workforce, we theorize exploration as a mediator in AI-driven HRM and resilience/adaptive performance. Therefore, this study contributes to our understanding by proposing that employees' explorative activities driven by their psychological needs may play a crucial role in promoting resilience and adaptive performance.

Second, we extend the SDT to reveal that trust in AI serves as a boundary condition through which AI-driven HRM attains beneficial outcomes by inducing explorative, resilient, and adaptive behaviors and performance. The extent to which AI-driven HRM encourages employees to explore, adapt to, and cooperate with AI technologies largely depends on their trust in AI to perform their work. Trust in AI thus makes employees more confident, competent, intrinsically motivated, and secure in experimenting with new approaches and technologies without fear of negative consequences (Glikson and Woolley, 2020; Kong et al., 2023). This subsequently fosters an environment conducive to exploration, where employees are encouraged to take risks, experiment, and learn new job-related skills regarding AI technologies.

Third, as no AI-driven HRM measure currently exists in the literature, we are pioneering the conceptualization and development of a new AI-driven HRM measure based on the HRM behavioral perspective (Dumont et al., 2017; Wright et al., 2001). This perspective is particularly significant as it underscores the need to understand how HRM practices shape employee attitudes, motivations, and behaviors to enhance organizational performance. Organizations can effectively achieve their strategic goals by aligning their HRM strategies with their desired employee behaviors. Doing so not only adds scholarly insight but also provides a starting point for future studies to advance this line of research. Finally, our study offers practical insights for HRM practitioners and organizational leaders seeking to leverage AI-driven HRM practices to enhance proactive employee behaviors such as exploration, resilience, and adaptive performance, as well as to foster a culture of collaboration between humans and AI in the digital age. Fig. 1 illustrates the hypotheses.

2. Theory and hypotheses

2.1. Self-determination theory (SDT)

SDT (Deci & Ryan, 1985; 2013; Ryan & Deci, 2017) provides a comprehensive framework for understanding work motivation and its effects on positive behavior and outcomes in organizational contexts. A central tenet of SDT is that individuals have psychological needs for autonomy, competence, and relatedness; when these needs are satisfied, they are more likely to experience intrinsic motivation, engagement, and positive behaviors (Gagné & Deci, 2005; Ryan & Deci, 2017). Social atmosphere, such as workplace climate, bolsters employees' self-determination and autonomy (Deci et al., 1994; Gagné & Deci, 2005). Following SDT, when employees perceive autonomy in their work, they are more likely to engage in proactive behaviors such as exploration, experimentation, and learning. Moreover, HRM practices such as training and development, and performance appraisal increase employee competence by providing tailored guidance, aligning tasks with skills, offering performance feedback, and facilitating skill recognition (Shipton et al., 2006). These aspects contribute to employees' sense of competence and confidence in their abilities within the organization. Finally, SDT underscores the importance of relatedness, which refers to an individual's sense of connection and belonging within their social context. HRM practices such as teamwork and job design that facilitate collaboration and communication are key to leveraging employees' explorative behaviors and self-learning.

This study proposes that AI-driven HRM is a transformational and adaptive system that helps meet employees' psychological needs for autonomy, competence, and relatedness. These psychological needs are likely to motivate employees to explore, learn, adapt to, and innovate in AI technologies. Thus, SDT provides a solid theoretical foundation for understanding the motivational mechanisms through which AI-driven HRM promotes employees' intrinsic motivation to influence their exploration, resilience, and adaptive behaviors.

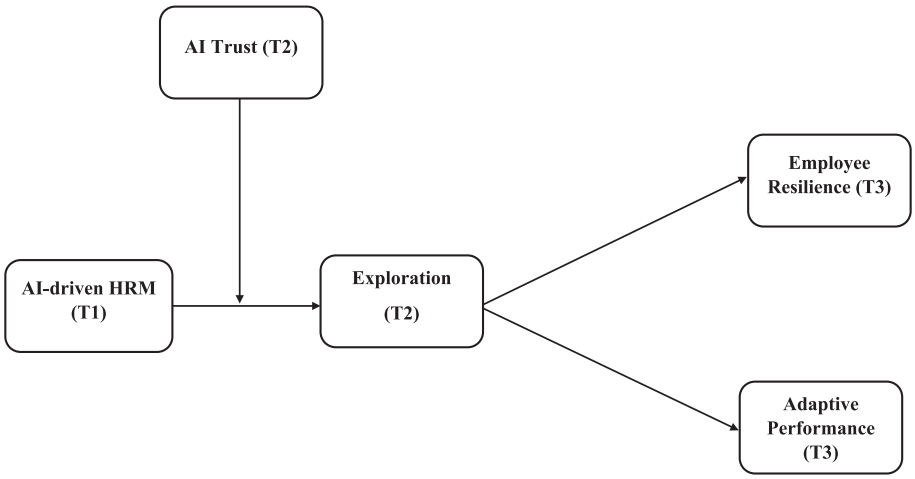


Fig. 1. Conceptual framework.

2.2. Towards conceptualizing AI-driven HRM

With the advent of AI technologies, such as pattern recognition, genetic algorithms, and deep learning (Jarrahi, 2018), many organizations now tend to transform their traditional HRM policies and practices by integrating AI applications and HRM. This is because traditional HR practices and processes may no longer be fully applicable in the context of rapidly evolving IT processes and practices, and conventional HR methods must be adapted to remain effective in the face of technological advancements and changing organizational dynamics (Angrave et al., 2016; Basu et al., 2023; Holtgrewe, 2014). By embracing AI in HRM practices, organizations are likely to remain competitive, agile, and adaptive in the digital age because AI can help them optimize HRM processes and functions (Malik et al., 2022; Papageorgiou, 2018). AI-driven HRM applications and practices are increasingly recognized as integral to strategic HRM discussions (Prikshat, Islam, Patel, Malik, Budhwar & Gupta, 2023; Kwan et al., 2019), especially in areas such as training and development (Maity, 2019), recruitment and selection (Van Esch et al., 2019), job design (Huang et al., 2019), and performance management (Leicht-Deobald et al., 2022). In this regard, we argue that HR can assess and shape employees' AI-related behavior, attitudes, knowledge, and motivation, which are essential for adapting to and working alongside AI counterparts. Accordingly, many organizations leverage HRM to effectively implement AI-driven HRM policies and practices.

Despite the increasing implementation of AI-driven HRM in the real world, our literature review suggests that there is limited understanding of AI-driven HRM and its effects on employee performance and well-being. Several pioneering scholars have focused on studying AI in HRM. For example, Strohmeier and Piazza (2015) have developed a conceptual framework to detect where AI-enhanced applications can be utilized for HRM purposes in areas such as training and development, recruitment and selection, performance management, and employee retention. Jia et al. (2018) have introduced the strategic and operational aspects of AI applications in HRM that may support HRM activities. However, these frameworks have been criticized for their lack of theoretical rigor (Prikshat, Malik, & Budhwar, 2023). Hence, Prikshat, Malik, & Budhwar (2023, p. 5) attempted to address this weakness by building on the Technology-Organization-People (TOP) framework, defining AI-augmented HRM as "the capacity of the HRM function to integrate with existing AI systems and utilize the latest AI technologies to ingest, process, and analyze data to aid problem-solving and decision-making for positive domain-specific operational, relational, and transformational consequences." Using a different terminology, Meijerink et al. (2021, p. 2547) define algorithmic HRM as "the use of software algorithms that operate based on digital data to augment HR-related decisions and/or to automate HRM activities."

Although the current frameworks/definitions lay the foundation for and provide guidance for examining AI-driven HRM (e.g., Jia et al., 2018; Meijerink et al., 2021; Prikshat, Malik, & Budhwar, 2023; Strohmeier & Piazza, 2015), none of these studies has drawn on the HRM behavioral perspective (Dumont et al., 2017; Wright et al., 2001) to conceptualize this construct. The HRM behavioral perspective is relevant because it provides a framework for designing HR practices that directly influence employee behavior, thereby linking HRM activities to organizational success and performance. It also helps organizations create HR strategies grounded in an understanding of how employees interact with various HR interventions, thereby leading to more effective and targeted HRM practices. However, these frameworks are still conceptual and have yet to be empirically tested. This study aims to address this gap in the literature by conceptualizing AI-driven HRM through the HRM behavioral view as well as the existing literature (e.g., Budhwar et al., 2022; Chowdhury et al., 2022; Chowdhury et al., 2023; Meijerink et al., 2021; Prikshat, Islam, Patel, Malik, Budhwar & Gupta, 2023; Wang et al., 2020) and empirically testing it. Therefore, we define AI-driven HRM as *a composite system that facilitates employees to acquire the AI knowledge, skills, and motivation needed to adapt to, communicate with, and work alongside AI counterparts to do their work, in turn helping organizations to achieve their strategic goals*.

AI-driven HRM includes two dimensions (employee adaptation and communication and human-AI collaboration) purposefully designed to enable employees to promote their AI-proactive behavior at work. First, employee adaptation is especially crucial, as it evidences whether employees can benefit from accepting AI technology (e.g., through increased productivity). Clear and transparent communication can enhance adaptation (Chowdhury et al., 2023). Additionally, collaboration between humans and AI technology is essential for developing AI-driven HRM interactive systems, which can enhance HRM efficiency (Prikshat, Malik, & Budhwar, 2023), competitive advantage, and business productivity (Chowdhury et al., 2023; Chowdhury et al., 2022). For example, through effective AI-driven HRM practices, employees are likely to develop AI competence, thereby improving their explorative and self-learning behaviors to adapt to and cooperate with AI technologies to accomplish their work tasks. These two dimensions of AI-based HRM are discussed in detail below.

2.2.1. Employee adaption and communication

With the rapid advancement of new technologies including AI, many organizations have incorporated AI-driven tools and systems into their operations. Employees must adapt to these technological changes by acquiring AI-related knowledge and skills (Chowdhury et al., 2022) to remain competitive and relevant in their respective fields and innovate

and solve complex problems using data-driven approaches. By understanding AI algorithms, machine learning techniques, and data analysis methods, employees can develop innovative solutions, optimize processes, and address challenges more effectively in their roles (Kong et al., 2023; Kostopoulos and Bozionelos, 2011). Regarding recruitment and selection, organizations utilizing AI tend to seek potential candidates with proficiency in AI-related tools, systems, and technologies. In this sense, organizations need to consider careful screening before selection to detect employees' AI expertise, intrinsic motivation, and the cognitive skills required to work with AI technologies (Jiang et al., 2014). Organizations can design job descriptions with requirements for knowledge and familiarity with AI applications, algorithms, and tools. Therefore, employees who are knowledgeable about AI and/or have undergone AI training are more likely to be identified and selected.

With the advent of new technologies such as AI, knowledge and skills can rapidly decline and become outdated. Therefore, organizations need to regularly design and implement training and development activities to update employees' knowledge and skills and offer employees opportunities to promote explorative learning behaviors (Jiang et al., 2014; Shipton et al., 2006). Effective investments in training and development can enable employees to develop their AI competence to meet their particular needs, cultivating organizational expertise concerning both the demand for and content for organizational operations and performance (Chen & Huang, 2009; Chowdhury et al., 2023). For example, employees trained in AI can leverage their skills to explore, learn, and experiment with AI technologies to perform tasks and duties more effectively. Linked with this, organizations should also design and implement performance appraisal and reward systems to encourage their employees to make use of their AI knowledge and skills to contribute to organizational goals more efficiently (Laursen & Foss, 2003) because these effective HR practices can help promote employees' intrinsic motivation (Jiang et al., 2014) and stimulate them to leverage their useful attributes such as exploration, self-development, self-learning, and resilience.

2.2.2. Human-AI collaboration

A study of 1,500 companies by Wilson and Daugherty (2018) indicates that organizations experience the most substantial enhancements in performance through collaboration between humans and AI technologies. This is because humans and AI have complementary advantages. The teamwork, leadership, creativity, and interpersonal abilities of humans complement the rapidity, scalability, and quantitative capacities of AI (Einola & Khoreva, 2023; Jia et al., 2023; Wilson & Daugherty, 2018). AI-human collaboration is therefore another important dimension of AI-driven HRM. AI-driven HRM policies and practices highlight the importance of teamwork and job design to ensure that employees cooperate and work alongside AI systems. For example, teamwork enables employees to collaborate effectively with AI systems by leveraging their strengths to achieve shared objectives. This collaboration fosters synergy between human workers and AI technologies, leading to enhanced productivity, innovation, and problem-solving capabilities (Beugelsdijk, 2008; Chowdhury et al., 2023; Jia et al., 2023; Wilson & Daugherty, 2018).

Furthermore, well-designed jobs that effectively integrate AI are essential for maximizing workflow efficiency and employee performance (Jia et al., 2023). By carefully designing roles that complement human expertise and AI capabilities, organizations can ensure that tasks are allocated appropriately, reducing redundancies and optimizing the effects of AI tools. In addition, HR practices, such as thoughtfully designed jobs that enable employees to participate in job-related decision-making, may present opportunities to explore, learn, and experiment (Batt, 2002; Liu et al., 2017). Proactive behaviors such as exploration, self-development, resilience, and adaptivity are fostered by aligning job responsibilities with employees' skills and interests, which in turn helps organizations achieve strategic goals.

3. Hypotheses development

3.1. The mediating role of exploration

Exploration entails "the pursuit of new knowledge, of things that might come to be known" (Levinthal & March, 1993, p. 105). Explorative activities refer to the proactive exploration and experimentation with AI technologies, allowing employees to take advantage of their autonomy and develop new AI knowledge and skills that are conducive to their work tasks and duties. These activities align with the key tenets of SDT by providing opportunities for employees to pursue personal interests, expand their skillsets, and experience a sense of mastery and self-directedness (Shalley et al., 2004). Employees are more likely to enhance their intrinsic motivation through explorative activities because they are involved in tasks that align with their interests and lead to a sense of competence and autonomy. This intrinsic motivation fosters greater resilience by enhancing employees' ability to adapt to challenges associated with AI technologies and other workplace challenges. Moreover, by engaging in explorative activities, employees are more likely to develop adaptive skills and behaviors that allow them to react fruitfully to changing business situations and environments and make use of opportunities for personal growth and development (Kauppila, 2018).

Accordingly, we draw upon SDT to argue that AI-driven HRM can lead to employees' explorative activities in the workplace by fostering intrinsic motivation, autonomy, competence, and relatedness (Deci & Ryan, 1985; 2013; Ryan & Deci, 2017). AI-driven HRM can promote a culture of exploration within organizations, encouraging employees to embrace self-learning, curiosity, and adaptability in the face of technological advancements and evolving business landscapes (Chang et al., 2014; Chen & Huang, 2009; Shipton et al., 2006). Specifically, AI-driven HRM practices that emphasize employee autonomy and mastery can stimulate intrinsic motivation, prompting individuals to engage in exploratory behaviors (Bos-Nehles et al., 2017; Jiang et al., 2014). When employees feel a sense of autonomy in their work, they are more likely to proactively seek new challenges, experiment with alternative approaches, and pursue learning opportunities related to AI systems and tools (Gong et al., 2013). Offering employees self-determination/autonomy to explore AI-driven tasks may stimulate them to take risks and initiate, self-determine, and innovate within their duties and roles. AI-driven HRM practices that support teamwork, self-directed learning, and collaborative problem solving can shape a desired work environment conducive to exploration, allowing employees to explore new ideas, methods, and technologies (Gong et al., 2013).

Furthermore, AI-driven HRM practices centered on skill development, training, and knowledge-sharing enable employees to enhance their competence in AI-related domains. As individuals acquire new skills and knowledge, they gain confidence in their ability to navigate complex AI-driven tasks and challenges, thereby motivating them to engage in explorative activities to expand their expertise and meaningfully contribute to organizational objectives (Kong et al., 2023; Zhang et al., 2022). Finally, AI-driven HRM practices that foster AI-supported collaboration and communication tools facilitating connections among employees are more likely to make employees feel a sense of belonging and relatedness, thereby engaging in exploratory learning behaviors.

Overall, we argue that the mediating role of explorative behaviors in the relationship between AI-driven HRM and resilience and adaptive performance underscores the importance of fostering the work environment. This can be achieved through AI-driven HRM practices that support employee autonomy, competence, and relatedness to promote their intrinsic motivation and ability to face and handle challenges in AI-driven workplaces. Therefore, we propose the following hypotheses:

Hypothesis 1. *AI-driven HRM is positively related to employee exploration.*

Hypothesis 2. *Employee exploration is positively related to (a) employee resilience and (b) adaptive performance.*

Hypothesis 3. *Employee exploration mediates the relationship between AI-driven HRM and (a) employee resilience and (b) adaptive performance.*

3.2. The moderating role of trust in AI

To gain further insights into the underlying mechanisms through which AI-driven HRM affects employee resilience and adaptive performance, we examine how trust in AI strengthens or weakens these relationships. Trust represents a psychological state that indicates an individual's inclination to depend on others and is rooted in optimistic anticipations regarding others' motives or actions (Rousseau et al., 1998). Trust has mainly been examined in the field of interpersonal relationships (Yuan et al., 2022). Recently, however, scholars have paid more attention to exploring trust in the AI literature, where there is an interaction between employees and technologies (e.g., Chowdhury et al., 2023; Hoff and Bashir, 2015; Kong et al., 2023). Therefore, it is argued that trust plays a vital role in human–AI interaction because this interaction may lead to possible risks owing to the complexity of AI behaviors (Kong et al., 2023; Omrani et al., 2022). The existing literature also claims that employees may view AI technology as reliable because its strengths, such as reliability, accuracy, and transparency, affect their cognitive trust and thus increase their trust in AI (Gkinko and Elbanna, 2023; Glikson and Woolley, 2020).

When employees trust AI technology to enable their work-related tasks and decisions effectively, they are intrinsically motivated to engage in, learn, and explore AI technologies. High levels of trust in AI reflect employee confidence and beliefs in the reliability, competence, and benevolence of AI systems. This trust enhances employees' positive attitudes towards AI and enables them to perceive AI-driven interventions as valuable tools that increase their autonomy by providing relevant information, resources, and support for decision-making and task execution (Chowdhury et al., 2022). In line with the SDT (Deci & Ryan, 1985; 2013; Ryan & Deci, 2017; Gagné & Deci, 2005; Greguras & Diefendorff, 2009), employees' trust in AI technologies plays a pivotal role in fulfilling their psychological needs of autonomy, competence, and relatedness and fostering positive outcomes such as exploration, resilience, and adaptive performance. Consequently, when employees exhibit higher levels of trust in AI, they are more likely to perceive AI-driven HRM practices as credible, supportive, and aligned with their needs and goals. This positive perception strengthens the mediated relationships between AI-driven HRM, resilience, and adaptive performance because employees feel empowered to explore and leverage AI technologies to overcome challenges, adapt to changing circumstances, and achieve their objectives. Thus, we hypothesize the following:

Hypothesis 4. *Trust in AI moderates the mediated relationship between AI-driven HRM and (a) resilience and (b) adaptive performance such that these relationships are stronger when the level of employees' trust in AI is higher.*

4. Methods

4.1. Study 1

Following established guidelines for scale development (e.g., DeVellis and Thorpe, 2021; Hinkin, 1998; Kong, Yin, Baruch & Yuan, 2023), we developed a new measure of AI-driven HRM. Firstly, we systematically reviewed the existing literature on AI in HRM to generate potential scale items. Secondly, we assessed the content validity of these newly developed items by consulting with managers from organizations employing AI technologies. Thirdly, we conducted exploratory factor analysis (EFA) on the items deemed valid to refine the scale further. Finally, we performed confirmatory factor analysis (CFA) to further verify the robustness of the factor structure.

4.1.1. Item generation and content validity testing

We first systematically reviewed the existing literature on AI in HRM and general HRM (e.g., Budhwar et al., 2022; Chowdhury et al., 2022; Chowdhury et al., 2023; Dumont et al., 2017; Malik et al., 2021; Prikshat, Malik, & Budhwar, 2023; Wright et al., 2001) and drafted 16 items to embrace the AI-driven HRM practices. Next, because practitioners' knowledge and experience about their HRM practices are integral to validation studies (Kong et al., 2023), we provided the definition of AI-driven HRM and these items to 50 managers from UK and US organizations employing AI technologies. In particular, participants were from Arts Design Entertainment and Recreation, Computer and Electronics, Manufacturing, Graphic Design, Information Services and Data Processing, Scientific or Technical Services, Software, Telecommunications, and Video Games industries that use AI-driven HRM practices frequently. These managers were recruited via the Prolific platform, a professional academic online data collection platform popular among management scholars (e.g., Sherf and Morrison, 2020). Each participating subordinate received around 1.50 lb after completing this study. They were asked to evaluate whether (a) these HRM practices are adopted and implemented within the organization or not, (b) there exist any wording issues, and (c) they would add any practices that are practiced in their organization but are not included in this measure. We then retained the items that > 70 % of the managers answered 'YES' if each HR practice is implemented in their organization. We were subsequently based on and synthesized these managers' inputs and recommendations to revise unclear language in representative items, yielding a final set of 12 items for exploratory factor analysis (EFA) scrutiny.

4.1.2. Exploratory factor analysis

We tested and validated the 12 items to a sample of 150 American employees who regularly work with AI technology to perform their duties and work tasks at work. Like the managerial sample, 150 participants were also recruited via the Prolific platform. Respondents were given the definition of AI-driven HRM and then asked to rate to what extent they agreed with the statements about AI-driven HRM practices within their organization (on a seven-point Likert-scale ranging from 1 = strongly disagree to 7 = strongly agree). A total of 150 valid responses were used to conduct the EFA, and the results illustrated in Table 1 support a two-factor structure (employee adaption and communication, and human-AI collaboration) with a twelve-item scale of AI-driven HRM. The factor loadings for each item (Table 1 –EFA test) were above the recommended lower limits of 0.50 and 0.45 (Bagozzi & Yi, 1988; Hair et al., 2014).[1]

4.1.3. Confirmatory factor analysis

We continued to confirm the results of the EFA by performing a CFA using the same approach. We collected another employee sample and followed the same procedure via the Prolific platform. We administered the questionnaires to 150 respondents. AI-driven HRM was measured using the 12-item scale, with a Cronbach's α value of 0.944. The items and factor loadings for the AI-driven HRM measure are reported in Table 1. Regarding the CFA results, the fit of the structure was acceptable: ($\chi 2/df$ = 141.94/53 = 2.68, CFI = 0.91, TLI = 0.89, RMSEA = 0.10, SRMR = 0.06). Similar to the results in EFA, Table 1 (CFA test) reveals that the factor loadings for each item were above the recommended lower limits of 0.50 and 0.45 (Bagozzi & Yi, 1988; Hair et al., 2014). Taken together, the results of Study 1 support a reliable and valid measure of AI-driven HRM. In Study 2, we aim to explore the

[1] To further validate our AI-driven HRM scale, we collected additional data and re-conducted both EFA and CFA, using a larger sample size (N = 398). The results of the EFA demonstrated consistent factor loadings and dimension patterns. Additionally, the CFA yielded the following fit indices: χ^2/df = 253.86/53 = 4.79, CFI = 0.96, TLI = 0.95, RMSEA = 0.098, and SRMR = 0.03.

Table 1
AI-driven HRM items and results of factor loadings (Study 1).

Item	Factor Loading			
	EFA −1	EFA −2	CFA −1	CFA −2
1. Employee adaption and communication				
Our company considers AI knowledge, skills and motivation as an additional criterion when hiring new employees.	0.68		0.74	
My company sets its AI application goals for employees.	0.77		0.84	
My company provides employees with fundamental AI training for streamlining their AI application.	0.79		0.89	
The sharing of AI knowledge is one of the criteria for performance appraisal.	0.74		0.79	
Our company rewards employees who apply AI knowledge and skills to their work.	0.63		0.68	
Our company offers training programmes that equip employees with updated AI knowledge and skills.	0.77		0.92	
Our company offers employees opportunities to develop their AI competence via training that meets their particular needs.	0.78		0.92	
2. Human-AI collaboration				
I work well with AI as a team.		0.75		0.65
I work alongside AI colleagues in performing some assigned tasks.		0.75		0.72
I am tasked with AI to perform certain tasks.		0.70		0.83
My job is designed in a way that I can cooperate with AI to do my work.		0.84		0.79
My job is more interesting and challenging when tasked with AI.		0.79		0.77
Cronbach's Alpha	*0.93*	*0.94*	*0.93*	*0.87*

Notes: N = 152; EFA = Exploratory factor analysis; CFA = Confirmatory factor analysis, Standardized factor loadings are presented; Cronbach's α of the 12-item AI-driven HRM scale in EFA and CFA are presented.

mechanisms and conditions under which AI-driven HRM affects employee resilience and adaptive performance via the mediation of employee exploration and the moderation of AI trust.

4.2. Study 2

Consistent with Study 1, we collected data from 500 American employees via the platform Prolific. Each participating subordinate received around 1 lb after completing a questionnaire. We collected data at three time points. At Time 1, we collected AI-driven HRM and demographic variables. Two weeks later at Time 2, we collected trust in AI and employee exploration. At Time 3 (2 weeks after Time 2), we collected employee resilience and adaptive performance. After eliminating missing and unmatched data, the final sample contained 274 participant responses. In this sample, 49 % were female, average job tenure was 7.25 years (standard deviation = 7.39), 23 % had completed high school, 47 % had Bachelor's degree, 30 % held an undergraduate above.

4.2.1. ***Measures*** *(to note that all the construct items are listed in Table 1A in the Appendices)*

AI-driven HRM. We measured AI-driven HRM scale using the 12-item scale with its two dimensions: employee adaption and communication, and human-AI collaboration that were empirically validated in Study 1 (shown in Table 1). The CFA results of Study 2 were acceptable: Chi-Square Test = 281.92/53, RMSEA = 0.12, CFI = 0.91, TLI = 0.89, SRMR = 0.05. Cronbach's alpha was 0.95.

Trust in AI. For moderator, we used Chowdhury et al. (2022)'s 11-item scale to measure trust in AI. The participants were asked to respond on a five-point Likert scale, ranging from 1 (completely disagree) to 5 (completely agree). One sample item is: "I believe AI technology can help in developing new skills which will benefit my career development activities". Cronbach's alpha was 0.91.

Employee exploration. For our mediator, we used Kauppila's (2018) 5-item scale to measure employee exploration. This scale's two ends of the continuum represent exploitation from the left side and exploration from the right side. The participants were asked to respond on a seven-point Likert scale ranging from 1 (completely agree with the statement of the left side and completely disagree with the statement on the right side) to 7 (completely agree with the statement of the right side and completely disagree with the statement on the left side). One sample item is: "During the past two weeks, I have particularly exploited my existing competences (exploitation, left side) or developed new competences to myself (exploration, right side)." Cronbach's alpha was 0.88.

Resilience. We used Näswall et al. (2019)'s 9-item scale to measure employee resilience. The participants were asked to respond on a five-point Likert scale ranging from 1 (almost never) to 5 (almost always). One sample item is "I learn from mistakes and improve the way I do my job". Cronbach's alpha was 0.85.

Adaptive performance. We measured this eight-item scale constituting three dimensions (adaptive reactivity, 3 items, adaptive creativity, 3 items, and interpersonal adaptivity, 2 items) adapted by Kaltiainen and Hakanen (2022). This scale was originally developed by Charbonnier-Voirin and Roussel (2012). The participants were asked to respond on a five-point Likert scale ranging from 1 (very rarely) to 5 (very often). One sample item was "I quickly decide on the actions to take to resolve problems". Given that this measure was dimensional, we conducted the CFA test of its three-factor structure. The results indicated that the three-factor structure fit with the data well: $\chi 2/df = 36.79/17 = 2.16$, CFI = 0.98, TLI = 0.96, RMSEA = 0.07, SRMR = 0.03. Cronbach's alpha was 0.88.

Control variables. Based on insights from previous research in HRM and AI (e.g., Malik et al., 2021), we included key employee demographics such as age, gender, work tenure, and educational level - as control variables. This approach was taken to account for and mitigate the potential confounding effects of these demographic factors on the relationship between AI-driven HRM practices and employee outcomes, thereby ensuring that our analysis more accurately reflects the impact of AI-driven HRM.

4.2.2. Measurement models

We conducted a series of CFAs to examine the distinctiveness of researched variables (Hu & Bentler, 1999). Due to the small sample size, we created parcels to reduce random errors and minimize distractions unrelated to the construct, thereby ensuring that the distribution of each target construct is close to the true construct distribution (Matsunaga, 2008). By creating parcels for variables based on their dimensions (for AI-driven HRM and adaptive performance) (Little, Rhemtulla, Gibson, & Schoemann, 2013), we ensured an accurate investigation of the relationships among the studied constructs (O'Reilly, Robinson, Berdahl & Banki, 2015). Specifically, we created two parcels for AI-driven HRM and three parcels for adaptive performance. Table 1B suggests that the five-factor model (comprising AI-driven HRM, trust in AI, employee exploration, resilience, and adaptive performance) provides a better fit than other possible models ($\chi^2/df = 825.42/395 = 2.09$, CFI = 0.90, TLI = 0.90, RMSEA = 0.06, SRMR = 0.06). This five-factor model fit the data well compared with alternative measurement models (See Table 1B in Appendices for detail). Therefore, the results suggest that the variables in our theoretical model were distinctive.

4.2.3. Results

As shown in Table 2, AI-driven HRM is positively correlated with employee exploration ($r = 0.27$, $p < 0.001$). Additionally, employee exploration is positively related to employee resilience ($r = 0.29$, $p < 0.001$) and adaptive performance ($r = 0.35$, $p < 0.001$).

Table 2
Descriptive Statistics, Correlations and Reliabilities.

Variable	MEAN	SD	Percentage
1. Employee gender	1.39	0.52	
male			61 %
female			34 %
Prefer not to say			5 %
2. Employee age	39.69	11.45	
20–30 years old			25 %
30–40 years old			34 %
40–50 years old			23 %
50–60 years old			13 %
Above 60 years old			5 %
3. Employee education	2.19	0.97	
High school diploma or equivalent			23 %
Colleague certificate or equivalent			47 %
Bachelor's degree			23 %
Master's degree			3 %
Doctoral degree			4 %
4. Employee tenure	7.25	7.39	
0–5 years			54 %
6–15 years			36 %
16–25 years			6 %
26–35 years			3 %
Above 35 years			1 %

4.2.3.1. Analytical strategy. We used MPlus (Muthén & Muthén, 2012) to do regression analyses to test our mediation and moderation hypotheses. In mediation testing, we built bootstrapping (Bootstrap = 10,000) mediation models to investigate the indirect relationship between AI driven HRM and resilience, as well as the relationship between AI-driven HRM and adaptive performance. For the moderated mediation, we use MPlus (Muthén & Muthén, 2012) to examine when trust in AI can strengthen these indirect relationships.

4.2.3.2. Hypothesis testing. Table 3 reveals that AI-driven HRM was positively related to employee exploration ($\beta = 0.24$, SE = 0.06, $p < 0.001$, Table 3) after controlling for demographic variables (i.e., employee gender, work tenure, education, and age). Additionally, employee exploration was positively related to resilience ($\beta = 0.15$, SE = 0.03, $p < 0.001$, Table 3) and adaptive performance ($\beta = 0.17$, SE = 0.03, $p < 0.001$, Table 3). Bootstrapping mediation analysis shows that employee exploration mediated the indirect relationship between AI driven HRM and resilience (indirect effect = 0.04, 95 % CI [.01, 0.06]), as well as the indirect relationship between AI-driven HRM and adaptive performance (indirect effect = 0.04, 95 % CI [.02, 0.06]). Thus, Hypotheses 1a and 1b were supported.

In Table 4, we present the moderated mediation models using MPlus (Muthén and Muthén, 2012). The interactive effect of AI-driven HRM and trust in AI on employee exploration was significant ($\beta = 0.21$, SE = 0.09, $p < 0.05$, Table 4), after controlling employee gender, work tenure, education, and age. The moderation effect was illustrated in Fig. 2. In particular, AI-driven HRM was positively related to resilience via employee exploration when trust in AI was higher (conditional indirect effect = 0.04, 95 % bias-corrected CI [.02, 0.06]). Differently, AI-driven HRM is not related to resilience via employee exploration when trust in AI was lower (conditional indirect effect = 0.00, 95 % bias-corrected CI [−0.02, 0.02]). Similarly, AI-driven HRM was positively

Table 4
Results of Structural Equation Modelling.

Variables	Exploration (T2)	Resilience (T3)	Adaptive performance (T3)
Employee gender	−0.13(0.10)	−0.13(0.10)	−0.14(0.07)*
Employee work tenure	−0.00(0.01)	−0.00(0.01)	−0.00(0.01)
Employee education	0.04(0.05)	0.04(0.05)	0.05(0.03)
Employee age	0.01(0.01)*	0.01(0.01)*	−0.00(0.00)
AI driven HRM (T1)	0.14(0.06)*		
Trust in AI (T2)	0.62(0.21)**		
AI-driven HRM (T1)* Trust in AI (T2)	0.38(0.12)**		
Exploration (T2)		0.21(0.04)***	0.25(0.04)***
R^2	0.15**	0.10*	0.15***
Indirect effect of AI-driven HRM (H3a)		0.03 ([.01, 0.05])	
Indirect effect of AI-driven HRM (H3b)			0.04 ([.01, 0.06])
Conditional indirect effect (H4a)			
Trust in AI (High)		0.30 ([.13, 0.46])	
Trust in AI (Low)		0.39 ([.17, 0.61])	
Conditional indirect effect (H4b)			
Trust in AI (High)			0.35 ([.17, 0.54])
Trust in AI (Low)			0.47 ([.22, 0.72])

Notes: N = 274; AI-driven HRM = Artificial Intelligence-driven Human Resource Management; Standard errors are reported in parentheses; Regression coefficients for the hypotheses are in bold; *p < 0.05; **p < 0.01; ***p < 0.001.

Table 3
Descriptive Statistics and Correlations.

Variable	MEAN	SD	Skewness	Kurtosis	Square root of AVE	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1. Employee gender	1.39	0.52	0.88	−0.35		–								
2. Employee age	39.69	11.45	0.65	0.20		0.22**	–							
3. Employee education	2.19	0.97	1.09	1.42		−0.07	−0.06	–						
4. Employee tenure	7.25	7.39	2.83	11.48		−0.05	0.42***	0.03						
5. AI driven HRM (T1)	4.86	1.33	−0.63	−0.18	0.63	−0.05	−0.13*	0.10	−0.05					
6. Trust in AI (T2)	4.01	0.60	−0.80	1.52	0.73	−0.17**	−0.18**	0.10	−0.01	0.51***				
7. Exploration (T2)	5.40	1.16	−0.58	0.01	0.82	−0.07	0.05	0.08	−0.01	0.27***	0.30***			
8. Resilience (T3)	4.01	0.60	−0.35	0.22	0.72	0.03	−0.02	0.10	−0.02	0.37***	0.41***	0.29***	(0.85)	
9. AP (T3)	3.93	0.58	−0.52	1.13	0.70	−0.17**	−0.04	0.13*	0.03	0.34***	0.44***	0.35***	0.70***	(0.88)

Notes. N = 274; AI-driven HRM = Artificial Intelligence driven Human Resource Management; AP = Adaptive performance; Internal reliabilities (alpha coefficients) for the overall constructs are given in parentheses along the diagonal; AVE refers to Average Variance Extracted.
*p < 0.05; **p < 0.01; ***p < 0.001.

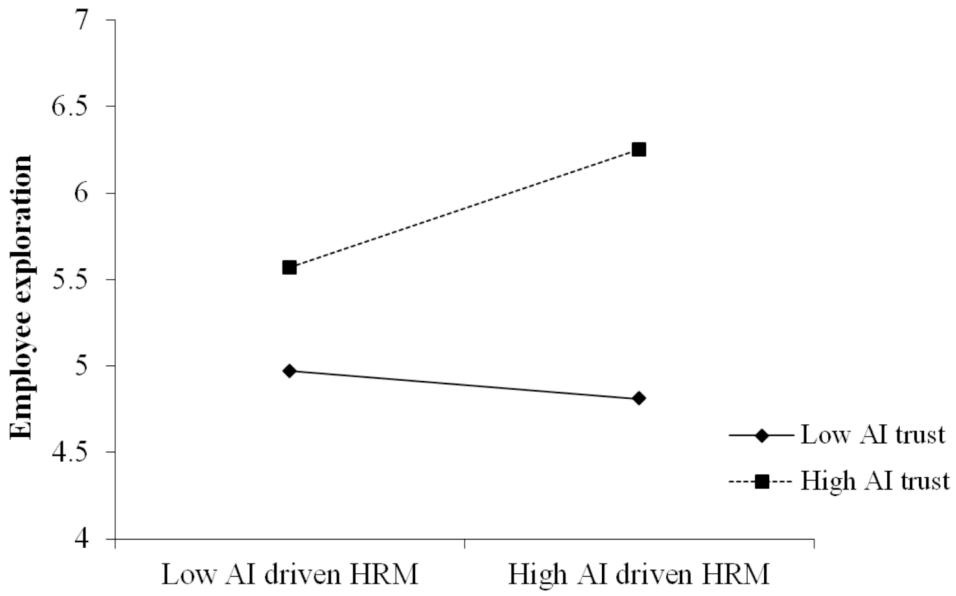


Fig. 2. Interactive effect of AI-driven HRM (Time 1) and trust in AI (Time 2) on employee exploration (Time 2).

related to adaptive performance via employee exploration when trust in AI was higher (conditional indirect effect = 0.04, 95 % bias-corrected CI [.02, 0.07]). While AI-driven HRM is not related to adaptive performance when trust in AI was lower (conditional indirect effect = 0.00, 95 % bias-corrected CI [−0.02, 0.02]). These results show that AI-driven HRM can only benefit employee resilience and adaptive performance via employee exploration when employees trust AI. Thus, Hypotheses 2a and 2b were supported.

4.2.3.3. Additional analyses. Given the dimensional nature of our independent variable, AI-driven HRM, we conducted additional analyses to examine how each dimension impacts the outcome variables. Specifically, we explored the relationship between employee adaptation and communication and the outcome variables − employee resilience and adaptive performance −through the mediating role of employee exploration.

Our bootstrapping mediation analysis revealed that employee exploration significantly mediated the relationship between adaptation and communication and both resilience (indirect effect = 0.03, 95 % CI [.01, 0.05]) and adaptive performance (indirect effect = 0.03, 95 % CI [.01, 0.05]). This indicates that higher levels of adaptation and communication enhance employee resilience and adaptive performance, primarily through increased exploratory behaviors.

Next, we tested whether trust in AI moderates the indirect effects of adaptation and communication on resilience and adaptive performance via exploration. The findings show that the positive relationship between adaptation and communication and resilience through exploration was amplified when trust in AI was higher (conditional indirect effect = 0.03, 95 % bias-corrected CI [.01, 0.05]) compared to when trust in AI was lower (conditional indirect effect = 0.01, 95 % bias-corrected CI [−0.02, 0.02]). Similarly, the positive relationship between adaptation and communication and adaptive performance via exploration was stronger when trust in AI was higher (conditional indirect effect = 0.03, 95 % bias-corrected CI [.01, 0.06]) rather than lower (conditional indirect effect = 0.00, 95 % bias-corrected CI [−0.02, 0.02]).

Likewise, we continued to examine the second dimension of AI-driven HRM, human-AI collaboration. The results remain consistent with the findings of AI-driven HRM as a single construct. In particular, the bootstrapping mediation analysis demonstrated that employee exploration significantly mediated the relationship between human-AI collaboration and both resilience (indirect effect = 0.04, 95 % CI [.01, 0.06]) and adaptive performance (indirect effect = 0.04, 95 % CI [.02, 0.06]). This suggests that human-AI collaboration enhances employee resilience and adaptive performance through the mechanism of increased exploratory behavior.

Furthermore, we investigated the moderating role of AI trust in this indirect relationship. The analysis revealed that human-AI collaboration was positively associated with resilience through employee exploration when trust in AI was higher (conditional indirect effect = 0.04, 95 % bias-corrected CI [.02, 0.07]) but not when trust in AI was lower (conditional indirect effect = − 0.00, 95 % bias-corrected CI [−0.02, 0.02]). Similarly, the positive relationship between human-AI collaboration and adaptive performance via employee exploration was stronger under conditions of high trust in AI (conditional indirect effect = 0.05, 95 % bias-corrected CI [.02, 0.07]) compared to low trust in AI (conditional indirect effect = − 0.00, 95 % bias-corrected CI [−0.02, 0.02]).

Taken as a whole, the results from examining each dimension of AI-driven HRM align with our primary analysis where AI-driven HRM was theorized as a single construct. This consistency reinforces the robustness and reliability of our approach in treating AI-driven HRM as a unified construct.

5. Discussion

This study aimed to explore the mechanisms underlying the theoretical relationships between AI-driven HRM and the resilience and adaptive performance of employees working with AI technology. Through different samples of data collected and analyzed in the two studies, we provide a holistic framework for the moderated mediation model of employee exploration and trust in AI underpinning the relationships between AI-driven HRM and employee resilience and adaptive performance.

5.1. Theoretical implications

Very limited research has focused on the effects of AI-driven HRM on employee resilience and adaptive performance despite constant calls for work in this area (Budhwar et al., 2023; Budhwar et al., 2022; Prikshat, Malik, & Budhwar, 2023). This study responds to these calls and advances the body of knowledge on the AI-driven HRM–resilience/adaptive performance association by revealing the respective roles of employee exploration and trust in AI. We believe that exploration and trust in AI are integral to making sense of the AI-driven HRM

environment, which, in turn, drives and enables a resilient and adaptive workforce in the face of constant technological change. Our study provides several insights on this topic.

First, our findings provide empirical support for the SDT application to understanding the mechanisms through which AI-driven HRM impacts employee resilience and adaptive performance. Specifically, when employees' psychological needs for autonomy, competence, and relatedness are addressed effectively in an AI-driven HRM environment, they are more likely to experience higher levels of intrinsic motivation. This motivation leads them to explore, learn, and adapt to new ideas, technologies, and ways of working. Consequently, they become more resilient and adaptive in their interactions with AI systems. By demonstrating that exploration, facilitated by satisfaction with autonomy, competence, and relatedness, serves as a mediator between AI-driven HRM and improved employee resilience and performance, our study advances SDT and reinforces it as a comprehensive explanatory framework that integrates the role of AI in HRM practices in the workplace.

Second, our findings illuminate the underlying mechanisms through which AI-driven HRM influences employee performance and well-being, particularly resilience and adaptability. By conceptualizing exploration as a mediator, we explain how employees can acquire both AI-related knowledge and motivation through effective AI-driven HRM practices, such as recruitment and selection, training and development, rewards, teamwork, and job design. These practices help employees develop the skills and confidence needed to engage in AI technologies, and foster a sense of competence and autonomy. By acquiring these attributes, they are more likely to feel self-determined and capable of exploring and experimenting with new tools and ways of working. This in turn enhances resilience and adaptive performance in increasingly technology-driven workplaces. Therefore, our study contributes to a deeper understanding of the dynamics involved in AI-driven HRM practices, offering insights into how organizations can successfully navigate ongoing technological changes.

Our findings emphasize the crucial role of trust in AI as a contextual attitude in explaining the relationship between AI-driven HRM, exploration, and employee outcomes. While trust is known to be essential in linking work motivation to performance, limited research has examined how trust enhances this connection (Kong et al., 2023). Our study addressed this gap by investigating the moderating role of trust in AI in intrinsically motivating employees to explore new ideas and ways of working. Our study contributes to a deeper understanding of how trust in AI can stimulate employees' intrinsic motivation and encourage their exploratory behavior. In turn, this helps employees adapt to and work effectively with AI technologies. Thus, our study advances the literature on trust in AI by offering insights into how fostering trust can support employee development and performance in the context of rapidly evolving AI-driven HRM practices.

Moreover, given the lack of standardized conceptualization and measures of AI-driven HRM, our study is the first to conceptualize, develop, empirically validate, and examine AI-driven HRM in a real-world context. Our research makes a significant contribution to the theoretical understanding of AI-driven HRM by clarifying its key dimensions and components. Based on SDT and addressing calls for research on AI in HRM (Budhwar et al., 2022; Margherita, 2022; Pereira et al., 2023), our study introduces the distinct concept of AI-driven HRM and demonstrates its impact on employees' trust in AI, exploration, resilience, and adaptive performance. This study bridges a critical gap in the literature and provides a foundation for future research in this evolving area.

Finally, our findings align with and extend the behavioral HRM literature by providing the following empirical evidence: (i) HRM might influence organizational performance by aligning HRM strategies with employee attitudes, motivations, and behaviors (Becker & Huselid 2006; Dumont et al., 2017; Wright et al., 2001), such as trust in AI (Alfes et al., 2012); and (ii) HRM practices significantly influence employee performance outcomes through underlying mechanisms (Jiang et al., 2012), such as employee exploration. This reinforces the view that HRM is not merely a function of managing people, but is integral to shaping the behavioral dynamics that drive organizational success (Becker & Huselid, 2006; Ulrich, 1996).

5.2. Practical implications

First, organizations can use the insights gained from our study to design AI-driven HRM initiatives that foster exploration among employees. By providing opportunities for learning and skill development regarding AI technologies and tools through effective AI-driven HRM practices, organizations are likely to empower employees to adapt to new challenges and enhance their resilience and adaptive performance.

Second, our findings reveal that trust in AI is one of the most context-related attitudes and attributes that can boost the positive impact of work motivation on employee behaviors and outcomes such as exploration, resilience, and adaptivity (Kong et al., 2023). Organizations should invest in AI-driven HRM initiatives to signal that they consider employees key assets and want them to be knowledgeable, skilled, and motivated, so that they are likely to explore, innovate, adapt to, and collaborate with new AI technologies. The effective outcomes and benefits of AI-based HRM can be achieved through clear communication from the organization and line managers as well as opportunities for employees to provide feedback and contribute to the development of AI-driven HRM practices.

Third, our findings imply that by leveraging AI-driven HRM practices to stimulate exploration among employees who trust in AI, organizations are likely to create a resilient and adaptive workforce in which employees are capable of adapting to today's increasingly dynamic and technology-driven business environments. Therefore, AI-driven HRM can enable organizations to survive, innovate, progress, and position themselves for success in the current business landscape.

5.3. Limitations of the study

A key strength of our study lies in its unique dataset, collected through a three-wave survey of a diverse US workforce engaged in AI. However, this study has several limitations. First, our datasets were collected online from the same sources (i.e., employee participants). Future research could conduct a field study using data from both subordinates and direct supervisors to minimize the common method bias (Podsakoff et al., 2003). Second, our new scale of AI-driven HRM was the first to be empirically examined; thus, it may influence other potential employee outcomes in addition to our current outcomes (employee exploration, resilience, and adaptive performance). Future research should explore other possible outcomes of AI-driven HRM, such as employee AI skills, AI knowledge sharing, and proactivity. Third, although employee occupation may influence attitudes, motivations, and behaviors towards AI-driven HRM practices (Kuvaas, 2008; Van Iddekinge et al., 2011), data on this variable were not collected. Future research should include employee occupation as a control variable to better understand its impact on the relationship between AI-driven HRM and employee behavior and performance. Finally, given that our AI-driven HRM scale was newly developed, future research should further examine the construct validity of its two dimensions to ensure that they accurately reflect distinct factors. For example, researchers should conduct additional factor analyses to assess the robustness of their factor structure or test the scale in different contexts to determine whether the dimensions hold consistently across diverse samples and settings.

6. Conclusion

In this study, we drew upon SDT to explore the underlying mechanisms and conditions under which AI-driven HRM influences employee

resilience and adaptive performance. Two studies were conducted using different samples from the US workforce. Study 1 tested and validated a novel AI-driven HRM measure. Study 2 (a three-wave survey) showed that exploration significantly mediates the relationships between AI-driven HRM and employee resilience and adaptive performance. Furthermore, trust in AI was found to be a salient boundary condition for strengthening the mediated relationships between AI-driven HRM and employee resilience and adaptive performance. Therefore, this study contributes to a comprehensive and integrated understanding of AI-driven HRM from an HRM behavioral perspective and its implications for developing a resilient and adaptive workforce in the AI era. This study lays the foundation for future research in this field and has important implications for organizations adopting and implementing AI technologies.

CRediT authorship contribution statement

Hoa Do: Writing – review & editing, Writing – original draft, Validation, Supervision, Software, Resources, Project administration, Methodology, Investigation, Data curation, Conceptualization. **Lin Xiao Chu:** Writing – review & editing, Validation, Project administration, Methodology, Investigation, Formal analysis, Data curation, Conceptualization. **Helen Shipton:** Writing – review & editing, Validation, Supervision, Resources, Methodology, Investigation, Conceptualization.

Declaration of competing interest

The authors declare that they have no known competing financial interests or personal relationships that could have appeared to influence the work reported in this paper.

Appendices.

Table 1A
Survey instrument.

Construct	No. Items	Rater	Author(s)	Item
AI-driven HRM	12	Employee	Self-development	See details in Table 1
Trust in AI	11	Employee	Chowdhury et al. (2022)	I have confidence in the use of AI technology
				I believe AI technology can facilitate with routine and trivial tasks through automation
				I believe my organisation will be able operate AI technology reliably or consistently without failing
				I believe that AI technology will consistently operate providing adequate and efficient results within a broad spectrum of processes
				I believe AI adoption will result in creation of new jobs
				I have a positive attitude towards adoption of AI
				I believe AI technology can help in developing new skills which will benefit my career development activities
				I have a positive attitude towards its impact of intra-organisational business operations
				I believe AI will positively change employee dynamics within the organisation
				AI adoption will not result in reduced focus on human skills such as creative intellect in my job
				I believe AI adoption will enhance the quality of my work
Employee exploration	5	Employee	Kauppila (2018)	During the past year, I have particularly…….
				Exploited my existing competences…….. Developed new competences to myself
				Worked on tasks that I am used to do…….. Started new tasks that I have not been familiar with before
				Used my current knowledge…….. Obtained new knowledge
				Developed knowledge in areas that support my existing competences…….. Developed knowledge in areas that are entirely new to me
				Learned to do old tasks better…….. Learned completely new tasks
Resilience	9	Employee	Näswall et al. (2019)	I effectively collaborate with others to handle unexpected challenges at work
				I successfully manage a high workload for long periods of time
				I resolve crises competently at work
				I learn from mistakes at work and improve the way I do my job
				I re-evaluate my performance and continually improve the way I do my work
				I effectively respond to feedback at work, even criticism
				I seek assistance to work when I need specific resources
				I approach managers when I need their support
				I use change at work as an opportunity for growth
Adaptive performance	8	Employee	Kaltiainen and Hakanen (2022)	I quickly decide on the actions to take to resolve problems
				I analyze possible solutions and their ramifications quickly to select the most appropriate one
				I easily recognize my work to adapt to the new circumstances
				I do not hesitate to go against established ideas and propose an innovative one
				I use a variety of resources/types of information to come up with an innovative solution
				I develop new tools and methods to solve a new problem
				I try to understand the viewpoints of my counterparts to improve my interaction with them
				I willingly adapt my behavior whenever I need to in order to work well with others
Controls	4	Employee	N/A	Employee age, gender, work tenure and educational level

Table 1B
Measurement model comparisons.

	RMSEA	CFI	TLI	SRMR	χ^2 (*df*)	$\Delta\chi^2$ (*df*)
Hypothesized five-factor model	0.06	0.90	0.90	0.06	825.42(395)	–
Four factor model (combine TR&EX)	0.10	0.76	0.74	0.10	1434.65(399)	609.23(4)***
Four factor model (combine RES&AP)	0.07	0.89	0.88	0.06	863.88(399)	38.46(4)***
Three factor model (combine TR&EX, combine RES&AP)	0.10	0.75	0.73	0.10	1470.59(402)	645.17(7)***
Two factor model (combine TR&EX&RES&AP)	0.14	0.57	0.54	0.12	2244.98(404)	1419.56(9)***
One factor model	0.13	0.53	0.50	0.12	2399.09(405)	1573.67(10)***

Notes: $N = 274$; AIHRM = Artificial Intelligence-driven Human Resource Management; TR = Artificial Intelligence Trust; EX = employee exploration; RES = resilience. AP is adaptive performance. RMSEA = Root Mean Square Error of Approximation; CFI = Comparative Fit Index; TLI = Tucker-Lewis Index; SRMR = Standardized Root Mean Square Residual; The baseline model is 4706.61(435); $***p < 0.001$.

Data availability

The data that has been used is confidential.

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